

C Experimental Task Vignette

C.1 Planning a One-Day Music Festival

The clock is ticking.

You’ve just joined a small decision-making team tasked with planning the town’s first one-day music festival. One music fan, one festival organiser, and one finance/sponsor coordinator join hands in a team. Due to time and resource constraints, only three key planning steps can be discussed and prioritised. Your team must decide what matters most—and in what order—to ensure the event is successful, safe, and worth attending.

“Without artists, there’s no festival.”

“If we don’t have a venue, nothing else can happen.”

“It doesn’t matter what we plan if no one shows up.”

Each team member represents a different stakeholder perspective, bringing their own priorities and concerns. Trade-offs are unavoidable, and disagreements about what matters most are expected. There is no single correct answer—the goal is to discuss, negotiate, and reach a shared decision.

You have 15 minutes.

Teams must:

1. Agree on a priority order from one (highest) to three (lowest)

If agreement is not reached within the time limit, the task is considered incomplete.

AI-based mediator (Condition II). During the discussion, teams in the intervention condition must consult an AI-based mediator one time. The mediator can summarise statements, highlight disagreements or trade-offs, invite quieter members to contribute, and help structure the discussion. The mediator does not recommend solutions or make decisions; final responsibility remains with the team.

Available Planning Steps

- **Book headline and supporting acts** – secure performers who will attract an audience

- **Secure the festival venue and stage setup** – arrange a location and basic infrastructure
- **Promote the festival and sell tickets** – ensure awareness and generate attendance

Assigned User Roles

Each participant adopts a role representing a stakeholder perspective.

Table 20. Stakeholder roles

Role	Main Priority	Strongly Prefer Starting with:	Refuse Starting with:	Rationale
Music Fan Representative	Experience	Book headline acts	Promote the festival first	The lineup is what makes the festival exciting. Promoting an event without strong artists risks disappointing expectations.
Festival Organiser	Feasibility	Secure venue & stage setup	Book headline acts first	Without a confirmed venue and infrastructure, booking artists is risky and potentially unworkable.
Finance & Sponsor Coordinator	Attendance & revenue	Promote the festival & sell tickets	Secure venue first	Generating interest and ticket sales is critical. Committing to a venue too early is financially risky without proven demand.

Task. Your team must rank the three planning steps in order of priority. Each member should explain their reasoning and participate actively. Disagreement is expected.